

You got Game



The Internet is the ideal arena for gaming challenges. But which games and where do you find them? Read on...

Gaming is no longer a geek thing! From bored secretaries playing *Solitaire* and *Bejeweled* to self-proclaimed gamers drooling over the scenery in *Serious Sam II*, everyone has a favourite game. We all love to boast about the scores we've achieved in the games we're obsessed with—this week's games at least.

Blame it on the competitive world we live in, and the rat race we're all trying to win—the fact is the thrill of a 'High Score' is like a drug. This substance abuse is no longer limited to teenagers, or the teens-at-heart—my mother, who can just about check e-mail, has developed a dependence on *Dynomite*, a game from Pop Cap Games.

Of course computer manufacturers are making the most of all this, and coming out with 'Gaming rigs' for those who need really high frames per second (fps) rates, anisotropic filtering, etc., while playing *Halo*, *Quake III*, *Serious Sam*, etc. Even gaming consoles such as Microsoft's Xbox and Sony's PS2 are gaining popularity, in turn making multi-player gaming more popular. How many of you out there with kids in the family have been bugged to chaperone an outing to McDonalds, more for the PS2 than the burgers? The ris-

ing Internet penetration also helps, as there's tons of competitiveness when playing multiplayer games. The thrill of playing a game against someone as far off as Iceland or Argentina is also addictive.

There are basically two different types of games—browser-based games and stand-alone games that connect to game servers. Browser-based games need no additional software to be installed on your machine, and are usually quite simple and straightforward. These include games from Yahoo! Games (<http://games.yahoo.com>) and MSN Gaming Zone (www.zone.com); both feature single as well as multiplayer games. Stand-alone games such as the *Quake* series, *Halo*, *Half-Life*, *Counter-Strike*, etc., need you to run the game and then connect to Internet game servers to participate in a game.

Nothing but ☺

Browser-based games are popular for two reasons. First, you don't need a high-end machine to play them, as they run within a browser window. Second, you don't need to install any major software.

Most games use the Java Run Time Environment, Macromedia Flash or Macromedia Shockwave players, you can install these from www.java.com and [http:// www.macrome-](http://www.macrome-)

